



CHINA AND TAIWAN



There are more than a billion people in China—more than any other country. In fact, almost a fifth of the world's entire population lives in China. Fifty-seven different ethnic groups live there, but by far the largest group is the Han, traditionally a peasant farming people.

Food and farming

Two-thirds of the Chinese people are farmers, growing crops on every spare patch of suitable land. Up to three crops of rice may be grown on the same paddy field each rice-growing season.

Rice is the basic food for China's huge population.



女人
Man
Woman

Words and pictures

The Chinese written language is based on pictures, which describe objects, actions, and ideas. There are about 50,000 pictures, or characters. A simplified list of about 2,000 is commonly used today.



Lettering brush



Communism in China

The Communist government in China plays an active role in people's everyday lives. This official government poster encouraged couples who live in cities to have only one child.

Bringing up baby

For many years there was a "one child per family" rule in China. It was introduced in 1979 to try to control the fast population growth. Since 2016, couples can have two children.

